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Hiring Committee
Center for Integrated Nanotechnologies

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the Quantum Technician rotation program at the Center for Integrated Nanotechnologies. For me, this program represents a rare opportunity to begin a long-term career at Sandia National Laboratories, an institution I deeply respect for its mission, work culture, and record of excellence as a national laboratory.

My background combines more than 20 years as a Set Lighting Technician with recent formal training through CNM Ingenuity's Quantum Technician Boot Camp—a program developed in partnership with Sandia to prepare local talent for quantum technician roles. In that program, I gained hands-on experience in optics and photonics, laser alignment, ultrahigh vacuum systems, spectroscopy, interferometry, and quantum optics experiments. I also developed practical skills in assembling optical and mechanical components, working with test equipment, maintaining organized workspaces, and following procedures in safety-critical environments.

In film and television, I built and aligned large-scale lighting systems, troubleshot electrical and power-distribution setups, read technical drawings, and worked with diverse teams under time pressure. I am comfortable with precision work, cable routing, soldering, equipment organization, and adapting quickly to new technical systems. I believe these strengths would allow me to contribute quickly while continuing to grow across different groups at CINT.

I am especially drawn to Sandia for its core purpose "to render exceptional service in the national interest" and its values: We serve the nation, We respect each other, We act with integrity, We deliver with excellence, and We team for great results. That mission-driven, team-oriented culture is exactly the kind of environment where I want to build my career.

I am also committed to remaining locally based in New Mexico. New Mexico is home, and my family's roots in this region go back generations, with deep connections to the land and history of this place. The chance to develop a quantum career here, while contributing to Sandia's mission and the broader scientific community in New Mexico, is very meaningful to me.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my hands-on technical background, quantum training, and commitment to New Mexico and Sandia's mission can support this rotation program.

Sincerely,
Ben Estrada